Newspapers by ancestry
https://www.newspapers.com/image/440846208

Downloaded on Jul 8, 2020

Connecting city youths to the world

By Gloria Negri
GLOBE STAFF

As a boy growing up in the Bedford-Stuyvesant section of Brooklyn, N.Y., Kenneth Granderson recalled it was almost a given that, "If you were a black teen-ager from Brooklyn interested in stereo and electronics, you were probably going to be a deejay."

He worked as a deejay while attending high school, but he had his sights set on the burgeoning information superhighway and enrolled at Massachusetts Institute of Technology, where he graduated in 1985 with a degree in electrical engineering.

Now 32 and the founder, president and chief software architect for Inner-City Software in Dorchester, Granderson is using technology to connect children from the city with a world outside their neighborhoods.

The effort puts Granderson, who calls himself "a technology evangelist," in the forefront of a new wave of entrepreneurs and academics offering black-oriented data on CD-ROM and on-line bulletin boards to discuss community issues, as well as developing encyclopedias of black history on CD-ROM.

Inner-City Software is among a pioneering group of fewer than a half-dozen companies in the nation involved in such work, according to Esme Bhan, who is helping establish a National African-American Museum at the Smithsonian Institution in Washington.

In conjunction with Black History Month, Granderson's company, run out of the second floor of his Dorchester home, has produced a new interactive CD-ROM based on Robert C. Hayden's book, "African-Americans in Boston: More than 350 Years." The CD-ROM will be distributed to schools, community centers and businesses.

The book, published two years ago by the Boston Public Library, chronicles the contributions of African-Americans here.

"We're hoping that by converting this book into a piece of technology that it will have greater appeal to the younger generations," Granderson said in an interview this week. "Most black kids don't see technology as something that is relevant to their experience.

"The need is to enable children to see the bigger picture. With the modem on these machines, you can connect the computer to a phone line. You can talk to the world. For a lot of black kids, their reality is their neighborhood. We want to use technology as a door for them to open up the world so they can see there is more to life than Blue Hill Avenue and Columbia Road."

While 90 percent of the software programs Granderson puts out is black-oriented, he has contracts with companies around the world related to other subjects.

He hopes his work can be as much of an influence on a new generation as his parents were on him. He credits his father, Aldwin, a postal worker, and his mother, Ilene, a secretary, for stressing the importance of education to him and his older brother, Eric, 36.

Though Granderson has worked for a decade in his field, he said the success of his current project was "a collaborative kind of venture with several inner-city black professionals and businesses." He credits Robotica Automation Consultants of Boston for doing much of the project management and hosting of the program. Funding for the project was mostly from private individuals, while Shawmut Bank helped pay for touch-screen machines at four public viewing sites.

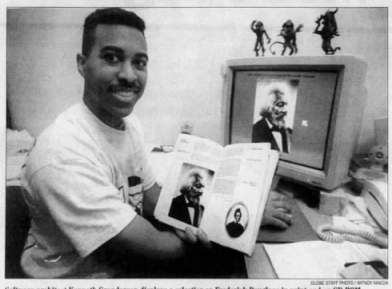
Those sites are located at the Copley Square branch of the Boston Public Library, the Children's Museum and Shawmut Bank locations at Federal Street and in the Washington Park Mall.

Ronald Mitchell, 33, an Emerson College graduate and head of RDM Productions, a multimedia production company in Roxbury, coordinates distribution of the CD-ROMs in schools and public viewing places. Mitchell said any school in the metropolitan Boston area that has the technology may use the CD-ROM free of charge, adding that Inner-City Software would help those schools that didn't have the technology to get it.

"This is not a money-making venture," Mitchell said. "It's about kids, history and technology."

Granderson said he hopes his fledgling company will be an inspiration to other city youths. "I want people to know," he said, "that black people can do those kind of things, to let kids say, 'These guys did it, maybe I can.'

"I'd like to talk to teachers about doing some educational programs. We need to build an alliance with other people, both in and out of the black community."



Software architect Kenneth Granderson displays a selection on Frederick Douglass in print and on CD-ROM.

GLOBE STAFF PHOTO / MITCH MASON

Council head wants to ban news boxes

Bid for regulation sparks call for an end to sidewalk 'blight'

By Michael Kenney
GLOBE STAFF

A proposal to regulate the location and upkeep of news vending boxes on Boston streets triggered a call yesterday from Boston City Council President James M. Kelly to ban them entirely.

At a public hearing of the council yesterday, the proposed ordinance, sponsored by Councilor Thomas Keane (Back Bay), won tentative support from representatives of newspapers, including The Boston Globe.

But Kelly called the boxes "a blight" and said he would like to see an outright ban. "I respect First Amendment rights," Kelly said, "but the Globe's right to have a place on the public sidewalk to sell papers is something else."

Godfrey W. Kauffmann Jr., the Globe's vice president for circulation, told the hearing before the council's Government Operations Committee that news boxes were "an important part of our sales efforts" and said the Globe was "very much in favor of being involved in developing regulations" similar to those in the proposed ordinance.

Kauffmann said the Globe had 800 to 1,000 news boxes in Boston. Estimates given by other publishers at the hearing suggested a total of more than 1,000 news boxes in the city owned by the Globe, the Boston Herald, USA Today and other daily and weekly newspapers.

Kelly's call for a ban on news boxes was joined by representatives of neighborhood associations on Beacon Hill and in the Back Bay. "We are asking the city to ban them," said Peter Thomson, president of the Beacon Hill Civic Association, who also suggested that the City Council "urge the publishers to voluntarily withdraw them."

The Beacon Hill Historical Commission, a city agency, is under a court injunction not to enforce its guidelines banning news boxes from the district while a challenge from newspaper publishers is before the federal Circuit Court of Appeals and the state's Supreme Judicial Court.

Keane said there was "no question that the council could pass an ordinance banning news boxes. And it is also no question that there would be a legal challenge to that. And it is no question that the challenge would be successful."

Natuzzi
ITALIAN LEATHER
Only part of our collection shown. More than 200 colors available in all. 32 colors available at the prices shown.
$597
$1598
$1211 SOFA WITH 2 RECLINERS
$1865 WITH 2 INCLINERS
$873 SLEEPER
$1891 WITH SLEEPER $2091
$528 RECLINER
$303
$378
4 DAYS ONLY!
Don't pay Showroom prices. Save Money! Buy direct from the WAREHOUSE
WAREHOUSE OUTLET
THE INTERNATIONAL HOME
Friday, Saturday & Monday 10-5; Sundays 12-5
CONTEMPORARY FURNITURE FROM AROUND THE WORLD
Delivery: Set-up additional • Limited Offer
(508) 879-9623

Founder of student aid program values community spirit

■ SCHOLARSHIPS
Continued from Page 17

Fradkin keeps his hand in, partly as mentor, partly as marketer, mostly as a mensch.

"I still get a thrill out of opening a chapter, of seeing the spark in kids' eyes when they realize someone they don't know wants to help," said Fradkin, who collects inspirational quotes, including this one: "We didn't want to give these kids a handout; we wanted to give them a hand up."

Known at the grass-roots level as "Dollars for Scholars," which Fradkin took as the title of his 1993 autobiography, the organization is actually based in St. Peter, Minn., south of Minneapolis. In the beginning, he says, no one in New England would donate office space. No one believed Fradkin could do it.

Except Fradkin. He says he believed in America, to which his Jewish parents emigrated from Russia before his birth. He also believed education was his way out of the family bakery business in Chelsea and on to a better standard of living. The foundation, which New England area director David W. Duncan says is as much about raising community expectations as it is about raising money, mingles two beliefs Fradkin holds dearest.

"I have a great appreciation for this country, and it breaks my heart how it's going down the drain," said Fradkin, his remarkably unlined face frowning for the briefest moment. "All this, 'Gimme, gimme.' People think this country is going to last forever, and it won't. Not unless we invest in our young people and teach them that they've got to give something back."

Fradkin doesn't mean to imply that scholarship recipients must repay the money, although many chapters encourage them to, and many recipients do. With more and more parents and communities worried about college costs, the number of chapters has tripled in the last six years. Foundation president William C. Nelsen says a new one is being added every four days or so.

The largest – and one of the oldest – is in Wakefield. Today its endowment stands at $1.7 million; this school year, it awarded 228 need-based scholarships worth $215,000 to residents.

"The average donation is around $100, which includes the many $5 donations we get and the trusts from people's wills that support us on an annual basis," said Wakefield office manager Lynne Zervas, who talks to Fradkin maybe a half-dozen times a year. ". . . He's inspiring. He had a dream and made it happen. Dr. Fradkin markets education as being key to democracy."

For the 1994-95 school year, his marketing strategy paid off for more than 2,500 Massachusetts students. The more than 60 Bay State chapters raised $2.8 million last year and gave away $1.5 million in chunks as small as $500 and as large as $5,000. The money might have gone to high school seniors headed to college, mothers hoping education will help them buck welfare or laid-off workers needing retraining.

All money collected at the local level goes toward scholarships or strengthening a chapter's endowment. Few employees draw paychecks; most are volunteers, like Fradkin has been since he started a scholarship fund here in 1958. Money for salaries or office space comes from grants and the group's for-profit sideline, managing scholarship programs for 550 corporations, which gave $30 million to students last year.

"What was unique about Dr. Fradkin's vision was that his idea was appropriate not just in Fall River but in every community," Duncan said. "He keeps us focused on the vision that the future really is in the hands of the young people."

For his continuing vision, the Isaiah Avila Memorial Foundation will honor Fradkin for his civic pride on Sunday. The motto of the group, which assists needy children in the Fall River area, is "Uncommon Common Man," which president Edgar Moore Sr. says Fradkin most certainly is.

Says Fradkin, who last year started another organization, the American Dream Challenge, to assist elementary school children, "There has to be more in life than just existing. . . . And I find that if you're not doing it for yourself, you can have the chutzpah to do a lot of wonderful things."

Single? call (617) 254-3000 LunchDates THE ONE WITH THE GOOD REPUTATION
New England's Largest Stock of Plexiglas® and Other Plastic Materials J. FREEMAN INC.
SALE
JOIN US FOR OUR PRESIDENTS' DAY SALE
We invite you to view our exceptional selection of fine, hand woven oriental carpets from Iran, India, China and Pakistan.
Brookline Oriental Rug Company
315 Hunnewell Street • Needham, MA
617-444-0333
Exit 19B off Rte. 128
Sale Hours: Monday thru Saturday 9–5

THE LOTTERY

Thursday number 2943

THURSDAY PAYOFFS (based on $1 bet)

EXACT ORDER

All 4 digits	$5,237
First or last 3	$733
Any 2 digits	$63
Any 1 digit	$6

ANY ORDER

All 4 digits	$218
First 3 digits	$122
Last 3 digits	$122

MASS CASH

Feb. 23: 15 18 20 25 33
Jackpot: $100,000

MEGABUCKS

Feb. 22: 1 17 23 26 30 37
Jackpot: $7,075,245; There was no jackpot winner.

PREVIOUS MASS. DRAWINGS

Wednesday	7236
Tuesday	5342
Monday	0317
Sunday	5321
Saturday	9413

THURSDAY NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND

Maine, N.H., Vermont
3-digit: 473 4-digit: 1170
Rhode Island
Wednesday's Powerball 32-48-43-44-45 Powerball 18
8571

Copyright © 2020 Newspapers.com. All Rights Reserved.
Powered by Newspapers.com